

1943, January 3

Mr. Charles Bracken
Page 3

The following is a faithful transcription of a carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

but directly and historically you have it (inasmuch as it is Christianity) as said before, from the "Mother Church" - call yourself what you may.

Like a drowning man who grasped my hand when only a youth, so now this poor patient seemed to hang on every word of hope. "Historisch" he repeated, "Historically? That is true! I'll do it." Next morning, about two hours earlier than the day before, he walked in seemingly quite a different person. There was color in his face and a smile on his countenance. He was twenty years younger looking as he walked over to the desk without stop or hesitation to greet me; "Guter Morgan" - (Good Morning.) "I came to see if I could start taking instructions today.

That he was feeling better was manifest. No one could doubt that who had seen him the day before I gave him over for instructions to Father Charles, a born Bavarian, who could naturally speak better German than one like myself and had more time at his disposal than I could possible give him. Eight weeks later, Sunday morning, I gave him his First Holy Communion myself, quite unexpectedly, and a week from the next day just as I had finished telling two ladies about him - one of them a Baptist with a cancerous breast - he, like rushed in thru the door, beaming all over to announce; " I just dropped in to tell you I am going back to work next Wednesday."

The above is a single case from many similar - I think I'd be safe to say one out of thousands. I very seldom go into such details and while I've tried to encourage quite a few cancer patients by telling them about this one, I have never written about it before. I hope it may not be a bore to anyone. On the contrary; may it be an inspiration and an example for many, not only for cases of eczema and cancer, but for whatever trouble may be met with. Our sad weakness today is our lack of faith and consequently, want of confidence in God.

In case you be in Detroit, or if, without too much inconvenience, the boy might be able to call down at the Monastery, I would be pleased to meet you. Hoping that by this time he is feeling improved and again wishing you and yours God's New Year's Blessing, I beg to remain,

Sincerely yours in Christ,

Fr. Solanus, O. F. M. Cap.,
/s/ Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.